justice in Havana's claims, and according to Dobrynin, Khrushchev raised it in a letter of 28 October that set out the details of their agreement.[27] The letter was explicit about the role of the missiles in Turkey and Italy, so Robert Kennedy returned it to Dobrynin. Guantánamo faded from Cold War diplomacy but reappeared in global consciousness as part of President George W. Bush's 'War on Terror' after the 9/11 attacks in 2001.

Consequences

Consequences are often lessons (rightly or wrongly) learned by participants in events. One lesson drawn by Bundy and others was that that the best way to manage a nuclear crisis was to avoid having one in the first place. In 1986 Eliot Cohen published an essay entitled 'Why We Should Stop Studying the Cuban Missile Crisis.'[28] In a world ruled by historians, such a statement would meet with terrible retribution. But Cohen's arguments are important. His ire was directed at those who drew theoretical approaches to crisis management from the events of October 1962. Applying these proved disastrous in Vietnam. Cohen inveighed against the 'parasitic breed that has flourished on the fringes of power in the past three decades – the policy analysts and kindred social scientists,' for whom 'history is a storehouse of data, which the irresponsible can plunder and the sober can explore.'[29] Sir Michael Howard makes a broader observation on the lessons of history: 'It is safer to start with the assumption that history, whatever its value in educating the judgement, teaches no "lessons" … The past is infinitely various, an inexhaustible storehouse of events from which we can prove anything or its contrary.'[30]

The suggestion that nuclear crisis management was a dangerous oxymoron emerged as a critique of those who believed that the threat (and use) of force could be carefully calibrated. Coercive diplomacy and statecraft proved a toxic formula in Vietnam when coupled with a belief that Kennedy had succeeded by his steadfastness. If Lyndon Johnson had been in the room when the Turkish deal was being worked out on 27 October,